

earliest examples of loader premiums was executed by Old Town Canoe in 1915. Co-owner Sam Gray began giving a premium to dealers who ordered a full railcar of forty canoes. Their orders were rewarded with duplicates of the full-size canoes. Stores ordering eighty canoes could receive either two four-foot duplicates or one eight-foot model. The miniature canoe models were works of art in wood and canvas. Old Town used this strategy until around 1940.

A more recent prime example of promotions to retailers was the 1990 Procter & Gamble “O” gauge model train set offered to those who displayed at least 180 cases of four of the six sponsoring Procter & Gamble brands, with over 15,000 stores participating. Each of the six cars in the set featured the logos of the sponsoring brands, including Folgers coffee, Sunny Delight, and Jif peanut butter. The store’s logo and color was even printed on the train’s locomotive.

One of the earliest marketing geniuses behind premium ploys was Sam Gold. An April 1949 *Life* magazine article called Gold the top idea man of the premium business. Born in 1900, Sam worked for Whitman Publishing Company in 1920, where he created and developed children’s books. By 1922, he had moved to Chicago and started his own company, the American Advertising and Research Corporation. The corporation produced children’s books along with premiums and displays. A maverick of his era, Sam believed that the world’s greatest salesman was a child—able to sell to mom and dad. This concept was the principle foundation of his business. It was Sam Gold who went to the cereal companies with his marketing plans that included displays, posters, and radio scripts (later television) aimed at